

I like parents. I've got parents of my own. Some of my best friends are parents. And not all parents react the same way; many get past the knee-jerk reaction. But I sense that, in many cases, parents use their kids as an excuse not to retire. I suppose if one wants an excuse, kids are as good a one as any. But this chapter has shown that it's entirely possible to retire with kids. Sam and Nick, the mentors you met in chapter 7, both retired with kids. And, more to the point, kids could very likely get as much out of retirement as Mom and Dad. After Mom and Dad retire, the kids get time with Mom and Dad when they need it most rather than when the time happens to be available. Perhaps for the first time ever, the kids have a mom and dad who can help them with their homework, take them to ball games, and watch them perform. In short, kids have a mom and dad full-time.

In the end, the question comes down to why you have kids in the first place. To provide them with the best money can buy? To play with them, to grow with them, to share their lives? If you work until you're 60, you may be able to send your kids to private college. If you retire young, you probably won't. But what means more to your kids: private college at age 20, or Mom and Dad's time and energy at age 10?

Working parents point to their kids and say, "I keep working to pay for them." Retired parents point to *their* kids and say, "I retired to be with them."